

Clean-Install Windows XP

We have looked at installing or upgrading Windows XP over a previously installed OS, say, Windows 98 or Windows ME. Now, let's look at installing Windows XP on a computer that has no previous OS installed. This is also called a clean installation of Windows XP.

Since we are installing Windows XP from scratch, you need to check the system requirements before you start installing Windows XP. If you have an older system and are installing Windows XP after wiping your hard drive clean, then download the Windows XP Upgrade Advisor first, and run it on your system before you format the drive. It will inform you which hardware and software is incompatible with Windows XP, and if the system is tough enough to install Windows XP. In fact, even before you go out and spend Rs 7,000 for a copy of Windows XP Professional we suggest you run the Upgrade Advisor on your computer.

For users with a brand new computer, compatibility with hardware is not an issue since all new hardware ships with XP-specific drivers. Once you have performed these preliminary checks and are satisfied, then move on to formatting and installing Windows XP on the hard drive. We have listed the steps you need to perform to clean install Windows XP.

1. Insert the Windows XP CD-ROM in the CD/DVD drive and restart the computer. Access the BIOS by pressing the [Del] key, go to the Advanced Settings in the BIOS, and change the Boot Sequence. The boot sequence should start with CD-ROM, then hard drive, and finally include the floppy drive. Then save the settings, and restart the computer when you are prompted.
2. When the computer reboots, you will see a screen asking you to press any key to boot from the CD. Go ahead.
3. The next screen is that of Windows XP loading files onto the hard drive. These are all blue and black MS-DOS screens, and